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2.4.6. Class: Osteichthyes

(G. *osteon* –bone; *ichthys* -fish)

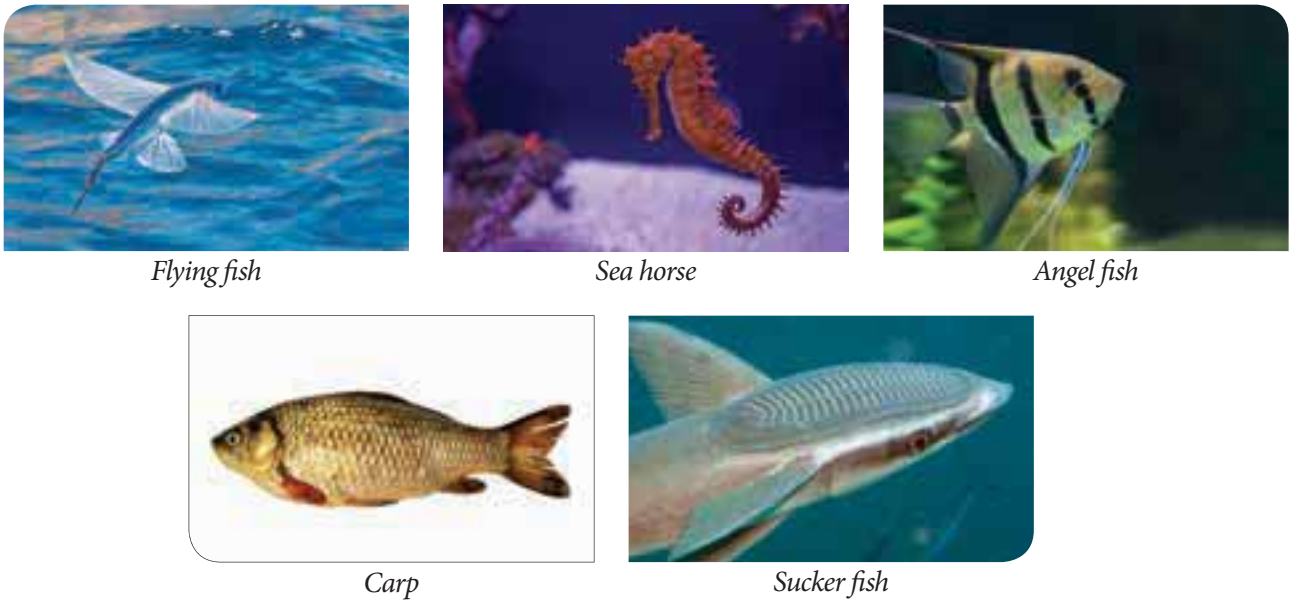
It includes both marine and freshwater fishes with bony endoskeleton and spindle shaped body. Skin is covered by ganoid, cycloid or ctenoid scales. Respiration is by four pairs of filamentous gills and is covered by an operculum on either side. Air bladder is present with or without a connection to the gut. It helps in gaseous exchange (lung fishes) and for maintaining buoyancy in most of the ray finned fishes. They have a ventrally placed two chambered heart. Excretory organs are mesonephric kidneys and are ammonotelic. Presence of well developed lateral line sense organ. Sexes are separate, external fertilization is seen and most forms are oviparous (Figure 2.25).

Examples: *Exocoetus* (Flying fish), *Hippocampus* (Sea horse), *Labeo* (Rohu), *Catla* (Catla), *Echeneis* (Sucker fish), *Pterophyllum* (Angel fish)



Shark *Pristis* *Sting ray*

Figure 2.24 Examples of Chondrichthyes



Flying fish *Sea horse* *Angel fish*

Carp *Sucker fish*

Figure 2.25 Examples of Osteichthyes